

DSAT Practice — Claim–Example Match

25 Solutions with Reasoning, Trap Alerts & Insights

Q1. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: The claim is that Thornton is 'solitary yet dependable'—prefers isolation but helps friends. A shows Thornton scowling at the interruption (solitary) but immediately pulling them inside and warming soup without complaint (dependable). Both traits are illustrated.

WHY WRONG: **A)** This is about Collings describing geography, not Thornton's character. | **C)** This is about Pemberton, not Thornton. | **D)** This is about Whitmore doing housework, not Thornton.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D tempts because it mentions a character doing something domestic at home (possibly solitary), but it's about Whitmore, not Thornton, and shows no dependability.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Both parts of the claim (solitary AND dependable) must appear in the quotation.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Scowling at interruption = solitary; warming soup without complaint = dependable → both traits = A.*

Q2. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Reyes claims pedestrian redesigns increase foot traffic to local businesses. An 18% retail sales increase after redesign directly supports this.

WHY WRONG: **A)** Driver preferences are irrelevant to foot traffic to businesses. | **C)** Road maintenance costs don't relate to foot traffic. | **D)** Concerns about losses don't support the claim; they question it.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D tempts because it involves businesses on redesigned streets, but expressing concern is not evidence of increased foot traffic.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Support requires evidence of the claimed effect (increased business), not just relevance to the topic.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Sales up 18% after redesign = direct support = A.*

Q3. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Yoon claims art activities help students grasp geometry faster. Students who drew shapes scoring higher on geometry tests directly supports this.

WHY WRONG: **A)** Parent opinions about art's importance don't relate to the claim. | **B)** Correlation between math skill and art quality doesn't show art activities cause better geometry learning. | **D)** Enrollment increases don't relate to geometry comprehension.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B tempts because it links math and art, but it shows correlation, not that art activities caused better geometry understanding.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *The support must show that art activities → better geometry outcomes, not just that math and art correlate.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Art activities → higher geometry scores = causal support = A.*

Q4. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: The claim is that Estelle is 'dissatisfied with her circumstances and eager to project an image of wealth.' A shows her entire bearing shifting the moment she puts on borrowed pearls—straightening, lifting her chin, adopting an airy tone unlike her shop-counter voice. The 'borrowed' detail confirms the wealth is not hers; the behavioral change shows projection.

WHY WRONG: **A)** This describes Roland's emotional state, not Estelle's dissatisfaction or projection. | **C)** This is the narrator reflecting on a parent's advice—unrelated to Estelle. | **D)** This describes a landlady's cat—no connection to Estelle.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B tempts because it describes a character's emotional transformation, but it's about Roland, not Estelle, and involves disbelief and happiness rather than wealth projection.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *The quotation must show both dissatisfaction with current circumstances AND projection of a wealthier image. 'Borrowed pearls' + changed bearing = both elements.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Borrowed pearls + changed bearing + different voice from shop counter = projecting wealth she doesn't have = A.*

Q5. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Tanaka claims sea urchin overpopulation causes kelp decline. If reducing urchins leads to kelp recovery, that directly supports the causal claim.

WHY WRONG: **A)** Temperature increases suggest an alternative cause, not support. | **B)** Atlantic kelp decline without urchins would actually weaken the claim. | **C)** Urchins preferring other algae would weaken the claim.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D is a classic DSAT trap: it introduces an alternative explanation that could actually undermine the claim.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Experimental removal of the proposed cause + recovery of the proposed effect = strongest causal support.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Remove urchins → kelp recovers = supports causal claim = A.*

Q6. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Chen claims railroads accelerated cultural integration. Towns along rail routes adopting distant customs faster than non-rail towns directly supports this.

WHY WRONG: **A)** Shipping costs are irrelevant to cultural integration. | **B)** Worker diversity during construction doesn't show cultural integration of communities. | **D)** Budget overruns don't relate to cultural exchange.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B tempts because diverse workers might seem relevant to cultural exchange, but the claim is about community-level cultural integration, not workforce diversity.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *The support must show cultural change in communities, not just diverse construction crews.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Rail towns adopted distant customs faster = cultural integration accelerated = A.*

Q7. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Okafor claims nature reduces attention fatigue more than urban environments. A park walk improving attention test scores more than a city walk directly supports this.

WHY WRONG: B) Rural vs. urban stress levels don't specifically address attention fatigue or matched exposure. | **C)** Enjoyment doesn't equate to attention restoration. | **D)** Diagnosis rates don't compare nature vs. urban exposure effects.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *C tempts because equal enjoyment might seem relevant, but the claim is about attention restoration, not enjoyment.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Support requires a direct comparison: same duration, different environments, different attention outcomes.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Park walk > city walk on attention test = direct support = A.*

Q8. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Farid claims whole grains improve afternoon attention. Students with whole-grain lunches showing consistent blood sugar and better afternoon focus directly supports this.

WHY WRONG: B) Parent preferences don't demonstrate cognitive effects. | **C)** Cost is irrelevant to the cognitive claim. | **D)** Eating vs. not eating is a different comparison from whole grain vs. refined grain.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D tempts because it shows lunch affects performance, but the claim is specifically about whole vs. refined grains, not eating vs. not eating.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *The support must compare the two specific conditions in the claim (whole vs. refined), not a different comparison.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Whole grain → stable blood sugar + better focus vs. refined grain = A.*

Q9. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Hayes argues social media expanded the range of voices in public debates. Underrepresented groups reporting greater political participation after adopting social media directly supports this expansion.

WHY WRONG: A) Low interaction counts might actually suggest limited engagement. | **B)** Time spent on platforms doesn't indicate expanded participation. | **D)** Similar knowledge levels don't address voice expansion.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *C tempts as relevant data about social media, but low interactions could actually undermine the 'expanded range of voices' claim.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Expanded range of voices' = more people from diverse backgrounds participating, not just more time online.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Underrepresented groups → more political participation via social media = expanded voices = A.*

Q10. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: The claim is that Elara's 'outward composure masks deep internal turbulence.' A shows her folding napkins precisely and answering with 'practiced calm' (composure) while aware of a 'tremor in her hands' visible only to herself (hidden turbulence). Both elements are present.

WHY WRONG: B) Gardening shows no internal turbulence or composure contrast. | **C)** Her brother arriving doesn't illustrate Elara's composure/turbulence contrast. | **D)** This describes other passengers, not Elara.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D describes restlessness, but it's about strangers, not Elara, and doesn't show the composure/turbulence contrast.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Both halves of the claim (outward composure AND internal turbulence) must appear in one quotation.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Practiced calm + tremor only she sees = composure masking turbulence = A.*

Q11. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Sutherland proposes beaver reintroduction accelerates native fish recovery. A 40% trout increase in beaver streams vs. no change in streams without beavers directly supports this.

WHY WRONG: A) More sediment/less clarity could actually suggest a negative effect. | **B)** Captive breeding rates don't relate to wild fish recovery. | **C)** Seasonal fluctuation with no trend doesn't show acceleration.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D tempts because it involves beaver dams and stream conditions, but it raises a concern rather than supporting the fish recovery claim.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Accelerates recovery' requires comparison: with beavers vs. without beavers showing faster improvement.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Beavers → 40% trout increase; no beavers → no change = accelerated recovery = A.*

Q12. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: The claim: Henrik 'uses humor to deflect from emotional vulnerability.' A shows him laughing and making a joke about the locksmith (humor) when asked about being hurt by someone leaving (emotional vulnerability), then looking away and saying nothing (the vulnerability beneath). All elements present.

WHY WRONG: A) Working on a roof shows diligence, not humor deflecting vulnerability. | **C)** Telling stories to children shows warmth, not deflecting vulnerability. | **D)** Watching snow silently shows introspection but no humor.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *C tempts because stories/humor are involved, but telling stories to children isn't deflecting from emotional vulnerability.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *The quotation must show humor specifically in response to an emotionally vulnerable moment.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Asked about being hurt → laughs/jokes → then silence = humor deflecting vulnerability = A.*

Q13. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Fischer argues bilingual code-switchers develop enhanced cognitive flexibility. Bilingual code-switchers scoring higher on rule-switching tasks directly supports this.

WHY WRONG: B) Larger vocabularies don't demonstrate cognitive flexibility. | **C)** Faster monolingual reading actually weakens the bilingual advantage claim. | **D)** Job satisfaction doesn't relate to cognitive flexibility.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B tempts because vocabulary is a language-related measure, but the claim is about cognitive flexibility (task-switching), not vocabulary size.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Cognitive flexibility' = ability to switch between rules/strategies, not vocabulary or reading speed.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Frequent code-switching + better rule-switching scores = enhanced flexibility = A.*

Q14. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Nwosu claims intercropping reduces pest damage without pesticides. 35% less stem borer damage in intercropped fields with no pesticides directly supports this.

WHY WRONG: A) Pesticide users having higher yields doesn't support the intercropping claim. | **C)** More harvest labor is a cost, not evidence of pest reduction. | **D)** If beans attract stem borers, intercropping would increase pest damage, weakening the claim.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D actually undermines the claim: if beans attract the pest, planting beans near maize would increase damage.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Support must show the specific benefit claimed (less pest damage) under the specific condition (no pesticides).*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Intercropped + no pesticides → 35% less damage = direct support = A.*

Q15. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Osei claims murals reinforced ruling-class authority by depicting royal ceremony and divine favor. Finding that throne rooms/audience halls disproportionately featured rulers with subjects and deities directly supports this political function.

WHY WRONG: A) Similar murals in non-elite buildings would actually weaken the 'reinforcing authority' claim. | **B)** Imported pigments show trade, not political function. | **D)** Non-political subjects in murals would weaken the claim.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *C actually undermines the claim: if ordinary people also had these murals, they wouldn't serve to distinguish the ruling class.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Support must show the murals were specifically in politically significant spaces depicting authority-related scenes.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Throne rooms + rulers receiving offerings + deities = political function = A.*

Q16. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Hassan claims community programs reduce falls more than home programs. 25% fewer falls in group classes vs. same exercises at home directly supports this comparison.

WHY WRONG: **A)** Cost comparisons don't address fall prevention effectiveness. | **B)** Social satisfaction is a different outcome than fall reduction. | **D)** No exercise vs. exercise is a different comparison than community vs. home.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D tempts because it involves falls and exercise, but it compares exercise vs. no exercise, not community vs. home programs.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *The claim compares two specific conditions (community vs. home); the support must compare those same conditions.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Same exercises, group vs. home → 25% fewer falls in group = community > home = A.*

Q17. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: The claim: Valentina's 'meticulous attention to detail professionally contrasts with disorder she tolerates personally.' A shows labeled folders, color-coded shelves, and a spotless desk (professional meticulousness) vs. unopened mail, unwashed mugs (personal disorder). Both sides of the contrast appear.

WHY WRONG: **A)** Colleague admiration shows only the professional side, not the personal disorder. | **C)** Preferring to work alone doesn't illustrate the professional/personal contrast. | **D)** Weekend volunteering doesn't show the contrast described in the claim.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B tempts because it supports the 'meticulous professional' half, but doesn't show the personal disorder that creates the contrast.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Contrast claims require BOTH sides to appear in the same quotation.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Office: perfect → Home: mess = professional/personal contrast = A.*

Q18. Correct Answer: C

REASONING: Liu argues minimum wage increases in low-cost areas don't cause significant job losses. No statistically significant employment change after a 15% wage increase in low-cost counties directly supports this.

WHY WRONG: **A)** Job satisfaction in high-cost areas is irrelevant to low-cost-area employment. | **B)** Higher inflation is a different outcome than job losses. | **D)** Models working in high-cost areas doesn't support the low-cost-area claim.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D tempts because it involves minimum wage and economic models, but it's about high-cost areas, not the low-cost areas Liu discusses.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *The support must match the specific conditions of the claim: low-cost areas + minimum wage increase + employment outcomes.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Low-cost counties + wage increase + no employment change = no significant job losses = A.*

Q19. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Stanton advocates neither automatically discarding the theory nor the intuition when they conflict, but re-examining both. A describes a philosopher who scrutinizes both the framework's assumptions AND the cultural origins of the intuition before deciding. This exemplifies Stanton's approach.

WHY WRONG: B) Discarding a theory based on one counterintuitive result = automatically siding with intuition, which Stanton opposes. | **C)** Accepting all intuitions = treating intuitions as infallible, which Stanton explicitly rejects. | **D)** Dismissing all intuitions = automatically discarding intuitions, which Stanton opposes.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *C tempts because it values intuitions, which Stanton does to some extent, but Stanton says intuitions are data points, not infallible guides.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Stanton's approach = examine BOTH sides of the conflict, not automatically favor either one.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Scrutinize both theory AND intuition before deciding = Stanton's method = A.*

Q20. Correct Answer: A

REASONING: Osman proposes ritual function. Figurines found exclusively in ceremonial areas (not in refuse or children's burials) strongly supports ritual use rather than play or art.

WHY WRONG: B) Geographic spread shows style distribution, not function. | **C)** Local clay sourcing says nothing about function. | **D)** Broken figurines could support either ritual (deliberate breaking) or play—it's ambiguous.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *D tempts because ritual breaking is a known archaeological concept, but without additional context, breakage alone is ambiguous and doesn't directly support ritual over play.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *Location of discovery (ceremonial vs. domestic vs. children's areas) is strong evidence for function.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Found only in ceremonial areas + absent from play/refuse contexts = ritual function = A.*

Q21. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Okafor characterizes the influence as 'adaptation' creating 'a fundamentally new rhythmic language,' not simple transfer. Finding combinations of West African polyrhythm + European harmony not found in either tradition alone directly supports adaptation (new synthesis) rather than transfer (copying).

WHY WRONG: A) Syncopation in many cultures doesn't address the specific West African → jazz relationship. | **B)** West African traditions remaining unchanged shows isolation, not the process of adaptation. | **C)** Lack of formal training doesn't demonstrate adaptation vs. transfer.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *B tempts because it's about West African drumming, but it describes unchanged traditions in isolated communities, which doesn't illuminate the adaptation process.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *'Fundamentally new' = combinations not found in either source tradition = synthesis, not copying.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Combined elements from both + found in neither alone = adaptation, not transfer = A.*

Q22. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Tanaka argues calorie info has limited effect because decisions are driven by habit/social context. If calorie counts produce no change even among people who read them, habit/context must be overriding the information—directly supporting Tanaka.

WHY WRONG: **A)** Decreased customer volume suggests people avoid the restaurant, not that food choices were unchanged. | **B)** Preference for no calorie counts doesn't show that the information doesn't change behavior. | **C)** A nutrition app reducing intake over months suggests a different context (personal tracking vs. restaurant), not directly relevant.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *C tempts because it involves calorie information changing behavior, but it's a different context (personal app vs. point-of-purchase) and actually suggests information CAN work—which would weaken Tanaka's claim.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *The strongest support shows the information present + noticed + yet no behavior change = habit wins.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Calorie counts displayed + read by customers + no change in orders = limited effect = A.*

Q23. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: The claim: Anand's ambition is 'tempered by persistent self-doubt that prevents him from fully committing.' A shows him drafting resignation letters (ambition to change his life) but never sending them (self-doubt preventing commitment), plus 'joined the others' indicates a pattern.

WHY WRONG: **A)** Missing the ship shows a consequence but not the internal ambition-vs-doubt mechanism. | **B)** Loving his work shows contentment, not ambition-tempered-by-doubt. | **C)** Thinking about uncorrected errors shows perfectionism but not the ambition/commitment conflict.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *C tempts because thinking about errors could seem like self-doubt, but it doesn't show ambition or failure to commit to a course of action.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *The claim has two specific parts: ambition (wanting to act) + self-doubt preventing commitment (not following through). Both must appear.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Writes resignation letters (ambition) + never sends them (self-doubt blocks commitment) = A.*

Q24. Correct Answer: B

REASONING: Holm argues models underestimate Arctic ice loss due to inadequate albedo feedback representation. Satellite data showing ice declining at twice the modeled rate, with the largest discrepancy where albedo feedback is most active, directly supports both claims (underestimation + albedo feedback as the cause).

WHY WRONG: **A)** Antarctic ice sheet predictions improving doesn't address Arctic sea ice or albedo feedback. | **C)** Constant albedo would actually undermine Holm's argument about the albedo feedback loop. | **D)** Accurate global temperature predictions don't address the specific Arctic ice issue.

■ **TRAP ALERT:** *C directly contradicts Holm's argument: if albedo hasn't changed, the feedback loop isn't operating as she claims.*

■ **KEY INSIGHT:** *The support must address BOTH parts of the argument: (1) models underestimate AND (2) the albedo feedback loop is the reason.*

■ **FAST METHOD:** *Observed decline >> modeled decline + worst where albedo feedback strongest = supports both parts = A.*

Q25. Correct Answer: D

REASONING: Okonkwo claims sleep deprivation specifically impairs consequentialist (outcome-based) reasoning, not deontological (rule-based) reasoning. Finding impairment on outcome dilemmas but not rule dilemmas directly supports this specificity claim.

WHY WRONG: A) If both types of reasoning were impaired, the claim of specificity would be undermined. |

B) General fatigue and slower response times don't demonstrate specificity to one type of moral reasoning. |

C) If activity reduced equally across all regions, the impairment wouldn't be specific to the prefrontal cortex—contradicting the argument.

■ *TRAP ALERT: D directly contradicts the specificity claim: impairment on both types = not specific to consequentialist reasoning.*

■ *KEY INSIGHT: 'Specificity' claims require evidence that X is affected but Y is not. Both must be measured.*

■ *FAST METHOD: Outcome dilemmas impaired + rule dilemmas intact = specific impairment = A.*

TOPIC SUMMARY

TOP 3 MISTAKES — Claim–Example Match:

1. Selecting a quotation that illustrates only one half of a two-part claim (e.g., showing composure but not the hidden turbulence).
2. Selecting a finding that is topically related but tests a different comparison than the one in the claim (e.g., exercise vs. no exercise when the claim compares community vs. home programs).
3. Selecting a finding that actually weakens the claim (e.g., an alternative cause when the claim identifies a specific cause).

TOP 3 RULES:

1. For quotation questions, ensure every element of the claim appears in the selected quotation.
2. For 'which finding supports' questions, check that the finding tests the exact comparison or mechanism stated in the claim.
3. Eliminate options that introduce alternative explanations, different contexts, or partial matches.

EXPECTED FREQUENCY: 2–3 questions per module. Claim-evidence and textual evidence questions appear consistently across both modules.